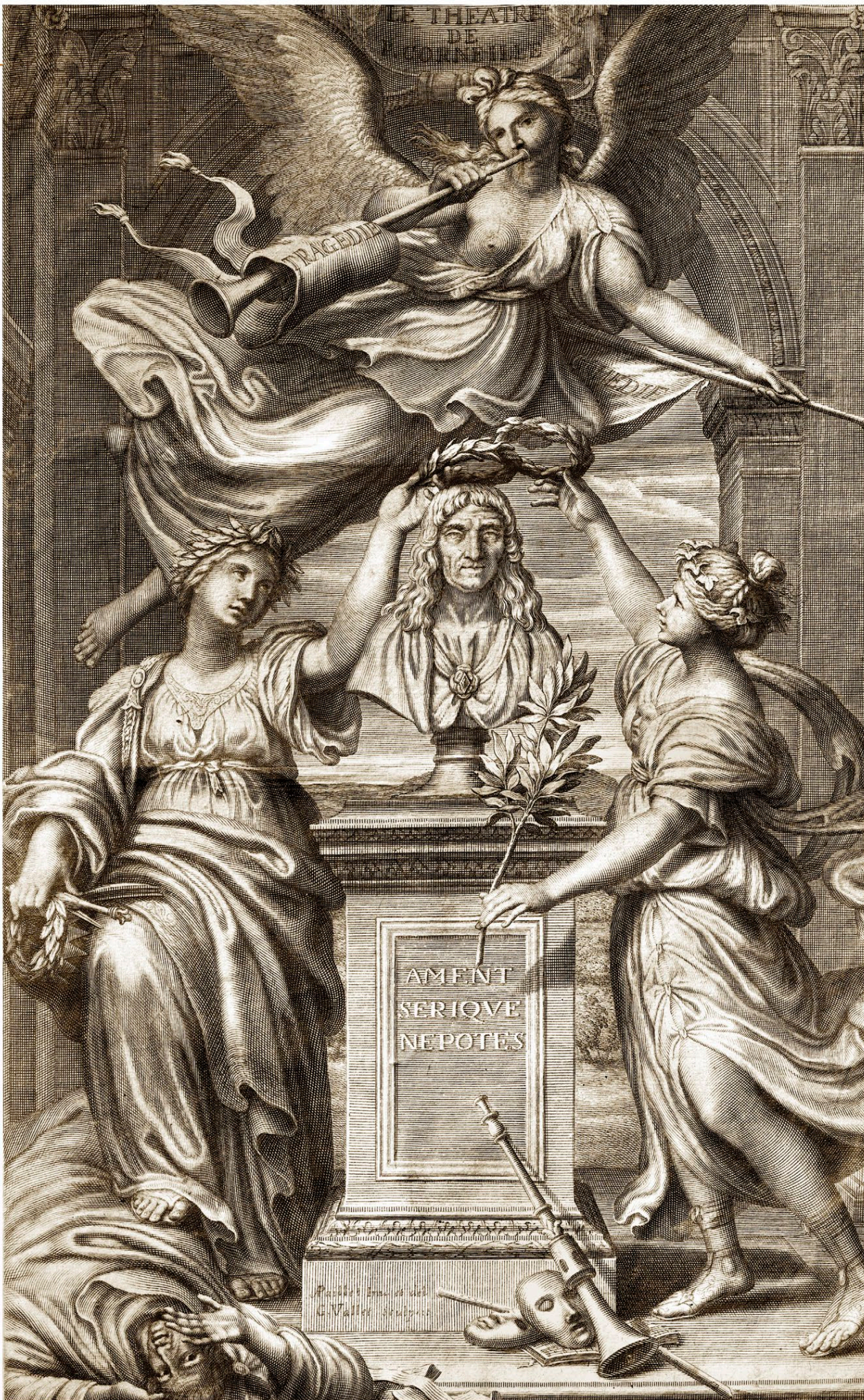




KEY

1 The airborne winged figure blows a trumpet to herald Corneille as a master of the twin skills of Tragedy and Comedy.

2 Crowns of laurel, the symbol of Greek god Apollo, show that Corneille is a leader in his field.

3 Figures of Comedy (right) and Tragedy (left) flank the playwright, who uses magic to blend the two in *L'illusion comique*.

4 Masks are ancient classical symbols of the theater and also help with disguise. In *L'illusion comique*, magic is entwined with mistaken identities.

◀ Master of illusion

This 1664 engraving for the frontispiece to an edition of Corneille's complete works places the playwright at the center. The works include *L'illusion comique*, a play that uses magic to summon up its theatrical universe.